

Learn, Grow, Teach Repeat!

how to be the senior that you needed
when you were a junior engineer

> whoami

Romedius Weiss

Senior Consultant @Open Reply

Backend / AWS Engineer

DevOps / Team Lead

<https://at.linkedin.com/in/romedius-weiss-20a147258>



Digital Solutions End-to-End



Bremen



Cologne



Innsbruck



Zagreb

10+

Design

50+

Backend

20+

Mobile

25+

Fullstack

5

Agile

Product Ownership/Consultancy

Technical Consultancy & Enterprise IT Architecture

Framework Facilitation (Scrum, SaFE, Coaching)

UX/UI, User Testing/User Research

Frontend Development (Web, Mobile, Multiplatform)

Backend Development (Cloud Custom Services)

DevOps

REPLY – Europe's leading network for digital innovation



16.000+

Employees worldwide

2,1 Billion

Euro turnover (2023)

50+

Offices

Work experience

- Freelancer
- one man Android department of a Startup
- Member of a Scrum Team of an external supplier for german Telekom
- Consultant -> Senior Consultant for REPLY @ OBI
- ... and different jobs / internships during my years at the university



less than half of the office during 2012 Internship in Kawasaki / Japan

Team Structure - the Agile Team



Junior



Midlevel



Senior

Team Structure - the Agile Team during Refinement



Junior



Midlevel



Senior

Junior - Team Newbie

- new Ideas
- no organizational blindness
- Why? How?
- Needs to learn how things are done
 - here
 - in general
- Small/well defined tasks and/or not critical ones

... for Juniors as in “new in the trade”

- (clear) Communication
- punctuality, what to search where ...
- learn to take responsibility



Oh, you can take over this feature, it is not that critical, give it a go :)



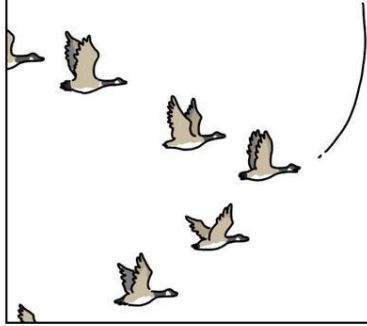
Ah, that feature you implemented is broken on prod - as you implemented it, can you take a look and fix it till EOB?

Midlevel - longer in the Team

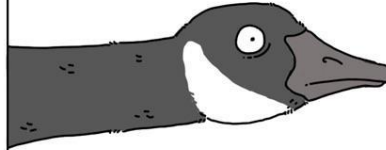
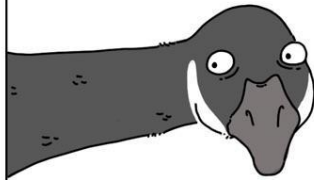
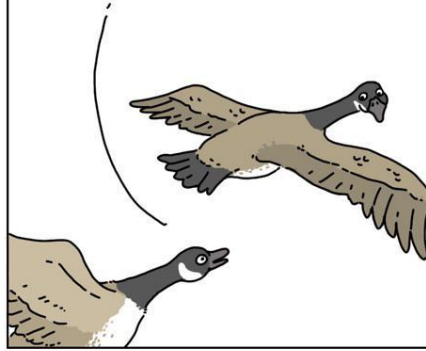
- Knows the how things are generally built (in a project)
- Backbone of the team
- Not that many overarching duties
- Works on tickets, can work with less interruptions
- needs some time from peers, returns the favor



so where are we going?



we're following you.



Team Senior

- Knows how the Project works
- designs big features (...with the Team)
- leads decision making processes from the technical side
- sparring partner for the product owner / manager
- protects the team from outside noise



Learn

- Ask questions early
- only dumb questions are the ones not asked or asked too late
- Try to be as precise as possible to save time
- Read Documentation - work on it together
- Learn how to write Documentation
 - of things that you asked and found
 - <https://developers.google.com/tech-writing>
- Challenge the written Documentation
- Why? Why? Why? How?
- Getting started: Start with small improvements

Grow

- Grow into new responsibilities and Roles
- Gain Speed and Efficiency!
- Build Standards for you and the people that come after you
- Automate things!
- Research standards that others have built (in other places)
- Build and participate in Peer to Peer Exchange formats
 - Community of Practice (in german Gilden...)

Teach

- Pass on your knowledge to Juniors and your Team
- Synchronously
 - Take time for regular sessions
 - Draft Documentation together for things where documentation is missing
 - Review Code together
- Asynchronously
 - Take care of your Wiki / Confluence
 - Review Code
 - Write technical documentation and design documents
 - Document Decision Processes
 - Write ADRs (Architecture decision records)
- There are no dumb questions
- Build an Environment of Trust!

Lead

- Protect your team from external noise
- distribute workloads according to knowledge and capabilities
- drive the vision of the team
- organize team growth
 - train your replacement
 - step 1: at least to be able to go on vacation
 - distribute knowledge and build resilience against sudden team changes
- ... learn to delegate

Repeat!

Change comes - if you search for it or if it finds you

In the next Team you are the new Person - maybe not the Junior

Q: How well do your skills/ your knowledge translate to new jobs and roles?

(Soft Skills, Hard Skills, Domain Specific Knowledge)

Q: is your Team resilient to change?

Q: How often do you need a new challenge?

Thank you!

One last Thing! Engineeringkiosk

Meetup in Innsbruck - monthly

<https://engineeringkiosk.dev>

Also join our discord community
:)

next September 11 2025

Engineering Kiosk Alps

Thursday, September 11, 2025

Meetup in Innsbruck

engineeringkiosk.dev/alps

hosted by



Cultural Kaleidoscope: India, Romania,
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